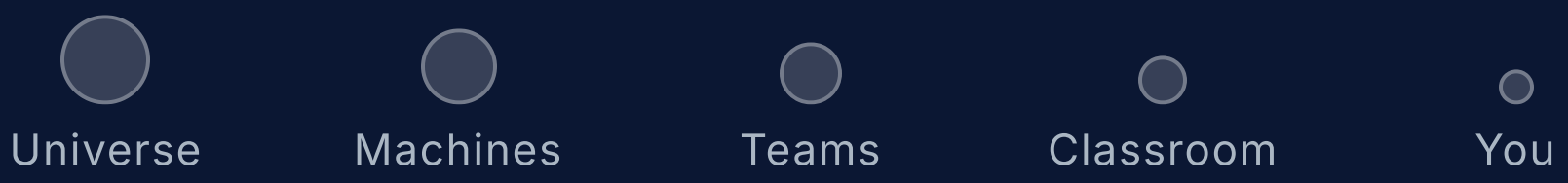
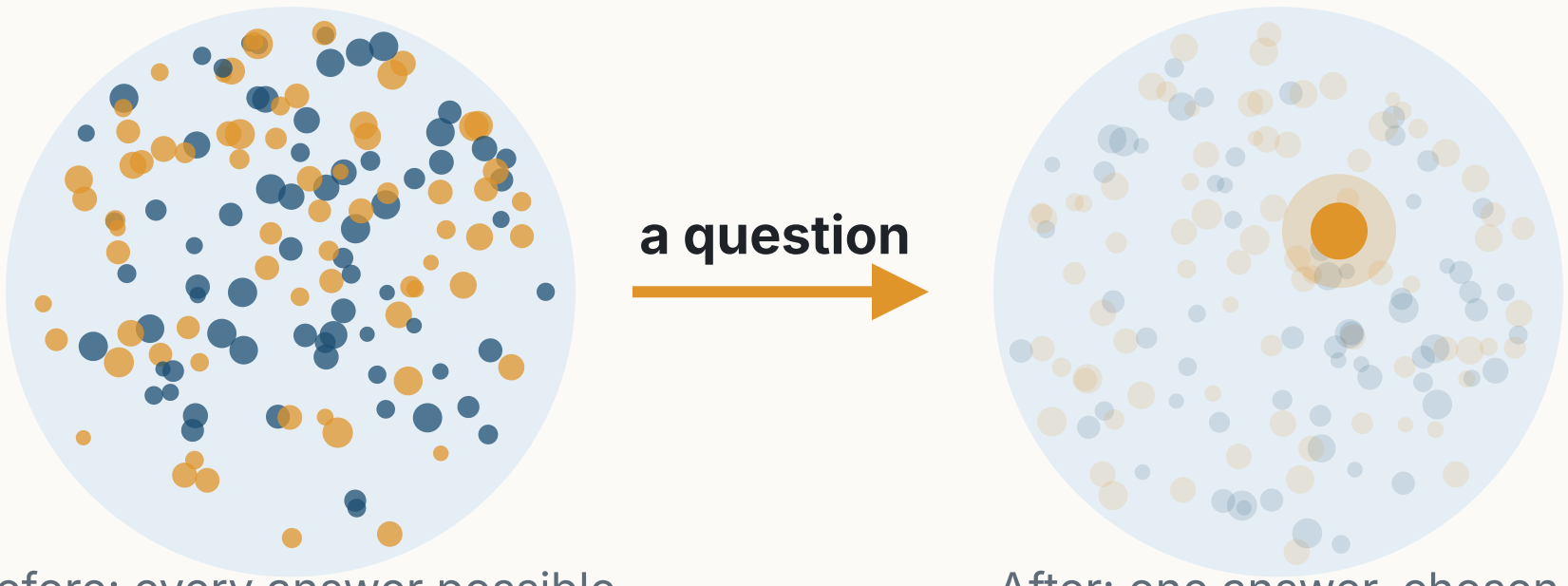
SIX ESSAYS, ONE QUESTION

Answers are cheap. Questions are ours.

What stays human when AI can answer almost anything, seen at five scales.



An answer needs someone asking.

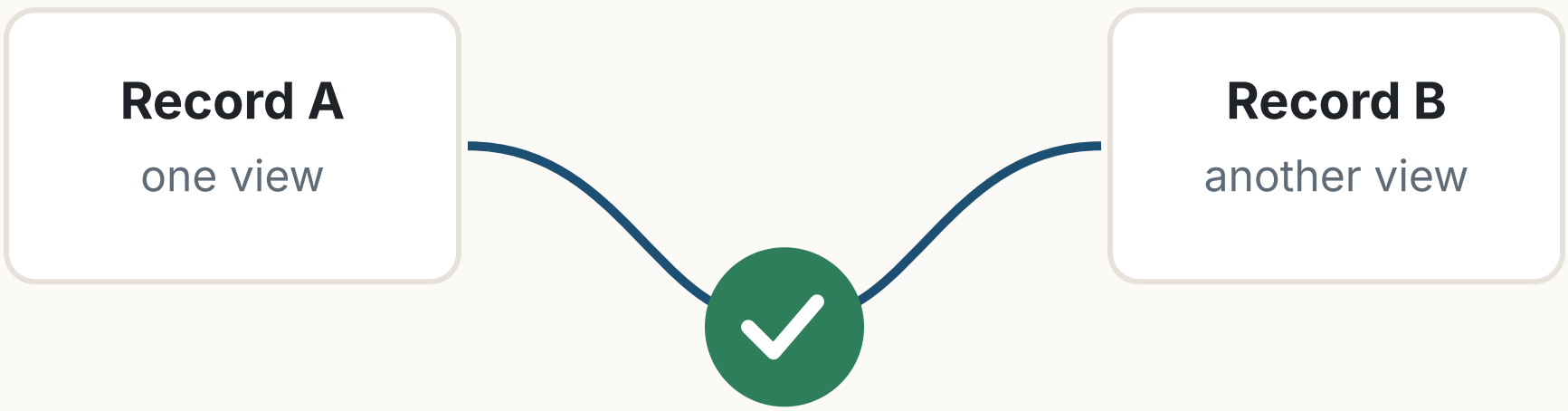


Before: every answer possible

After: one answer, chosen

In recent calculations, a closed universe seen from outside holds nothing to know. Information begins with someone inside, asking. A language model works a bit like that: every answer waits until a question arrives.

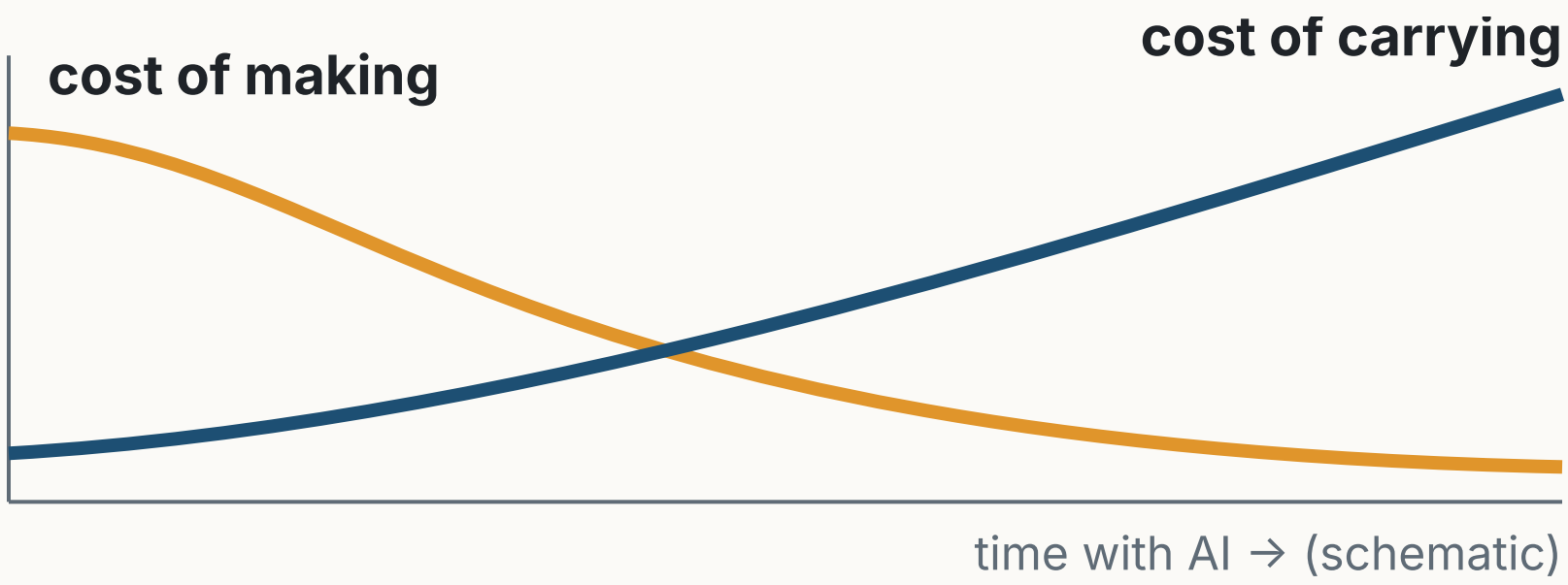
Agreement is not truth.



they meet, and agree

Ten of my models that agreed were right **99.8%** of the time, unless they had all learned the same mistake. Then their agreement was worth no more than chance. Compare, then check against the world.

Everything you make, you carry.



AI lowers the cost of making, not of carrying. So make less, approve only what you cannot undo, watch the rest, and keep processes light.

The skill is in the effort.

−17%



Practised with a plain chatbot

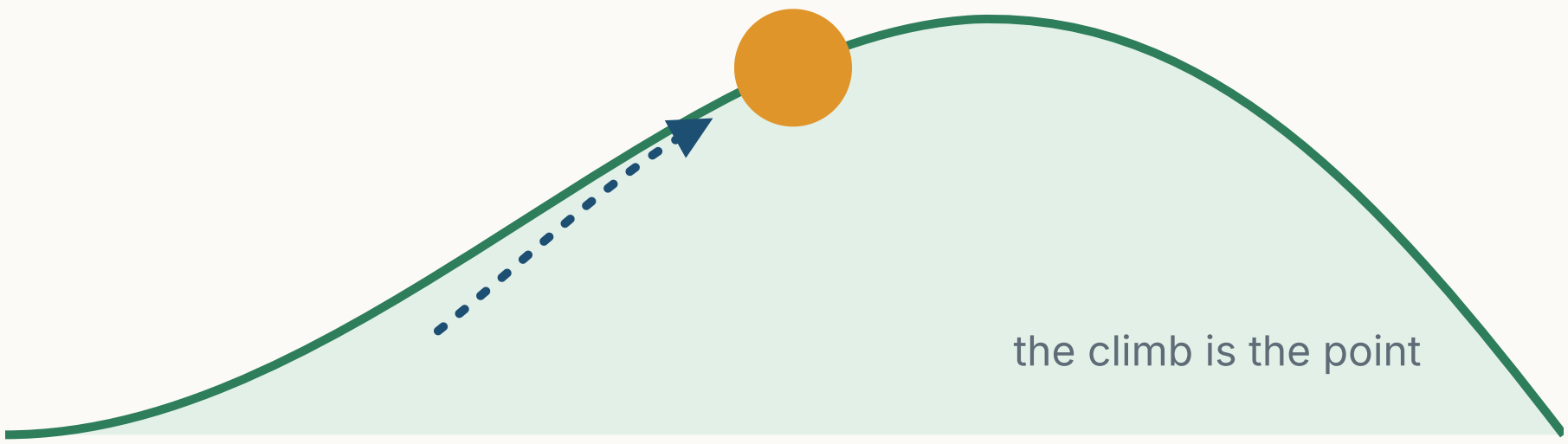
≈ 0

Practised with a tutor that gives hints, not answers

Exam scores once the AI was taken away, compared with students who never had it (~1,000 students; Bastani et al., *PNAS*, 2025)

A tool that does the climbing for you takes the learning with it. A tool that keeps the effort does no harm.

A machine has no reason to want an answer. We do.



“One must imagine Sisyphus happy,” wrote Camus. Being first at the top is not the same as being glad to be there. Choosing the question, and caring about it, stays ours.

Answers are cheap.
Questions are ours.

Ask your own question.
An answer means something only to someone.

Compare, then check against the world.
Agreement is not truth.

Carry only what matters.
Making is free; keeping is not.

Keep the effort, and the joy.
That is where the skill comes from.

What question would you never hand to a machine?

Essays, experiments and code, in English and French

scuenat.github.io

Tell me in the comments. Good questions often become the next essay.